

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*

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## Faye Stop

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*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

# INTRODUCTIONS



## Faye Stop

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### *Gala Photographer & Editorial Portraitist*

Faye will ask you to move half an inch until the end of time. Faye photographs artists, collectors, and public figures for magazines that describe parties like tonight as 'intimate' despite inviting two hundred people.

- Has photographed several investigations for **Paige Turner**.
- **Dada DiCapo** loves Faye's work because Faye does not overdirect.

### **ACTING TIPS**

Observant, understated, curious, visually minded. You notice who is standing with whom and what happens at the edge of a room.

### **YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD**

I'm Faye Stop. I am your photographer. Give me your good side, then try not to confess anything while I have the camera up.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*



Faye Stop

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## Behind the portrait

### Your grievance with Grant

Grant ordered you to surrender a photograph showing him meeting privately with Hugh beside a shell-company shipping file.

### Your other secret

You kept a backup print after agreeing to delete the image from your camera.

### Conversations to start

- Ask Paige Turner whether a photograph can be newsworthy without its owner's permission.
- Ask Hugh Bidder why a donor might object to being photographed beside a shipping file.

*One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.*

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



# The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A silent encore waits under the instrument with black and white keys.*
- 2 *The route to this discovery runs through a map of the Catalan capital.*
- 3 *Something has slipped behind the soft blue square on the seat.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**  
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Faye Stop

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## Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did Grant ask you to hide?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What did you want returned or protected?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

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*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

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Faye Stop

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

I agreed to delete the camera image and kept a backup print. It shows Grant and Hugh beside the shipping papers. I was there to record the gala. He wanted to decide which parts of it had happened. I let him believe the deletion covered every copy. I was unwilling to hand over the print, although keeping it meant breaking my word.

#### IF MURDERER

I agreed to delete the camera image and kept a backup print. It shows Grant and Hugh beside the shipping papers. I was there to record the gala. He wanted to decide which parts of it had happened. I let him believe the deletion covered every copy. Once I had seen the papers in that picture, I could not accept his deciding whether it survived.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**  
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Faye Stop

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme**

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid**

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

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**Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance**

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

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**Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks**

Describe your errand at the private service station.

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**Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates**

What physical work or problem occupied you?

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**Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic**

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

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**Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel**

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

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**Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist**

What practical museum duty were you handling?

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**Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher**

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

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**Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop**

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

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*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

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## ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Faye Stop

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

I took the backup print out of the display photographer's work tray after Grant ordered the camera file deleted. The print showed his meeting beside the shipping papers. I hid it in my own sleeve instead of handing it over. He saw the empty tray and asked whether every copy was gone. I said the file had been deleted. I intended him to hear a broader answer, and I knew that distinction would not protect me if he found the print.

#### IF MURDERER

I took the backup print out of the display photographer's work tray after Grant ordered the camera file deleted. The print showed his meeting beside the shipping papers. I hid it in my own sleeve instead of handing it over. He saw the empty tray and asked whether every copy was gone. I said the file had been deleted. I intended him to hear a broader answer, and I knew that distinction would not protect me if he found the print.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**  
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



### Faye Stop

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## Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact**

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

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**Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist**

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

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**Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates**

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate**

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

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**Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher**

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

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**Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks**

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

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**Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop**

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote**

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

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**Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme**

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

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*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

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Faye Stop

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

The separate print predates my promise to delete the camera image. The lab kept the print order, and the image includes the shipping papers beside Grant's meeting. I concealed a copy from him; I did not fabricate what it shows. The original print order accounts for the photograph he thought I had made disappear.

#### IF MURDERER

I promised Grant that the camera file was gone and retained the separate print. He wanted every copy destroyed. The shipping papers in the image were the reason I would not do that. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my print sleeve. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass before laying the retained photograph beside him.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
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Faye Stop

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## Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

**Your character name**

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**I accuse**

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**Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction**

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**Best Actor**

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**Best Costume**

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# The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

## IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I retained the print and let Grant believe deleting the file had destroyed every copy. The original print order survives. I did not kill him. I will supply the photograph with its actual date and explain the selective answer I gave. The shipping papers in that image deserve investigation without another deletion.

## IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my print sleeve when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He wanted the retained photograph destroyed. I killed him to preserve evidence of a different crime.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*